

DAVID MULLIN

Mullin's 87 Rewrites His Deal Best

Par, birdie, par, par from the 9th produced 13 points in four holes and turned a course that took 94 off him in TEG 13 into a personal best by seven.

David Mullin's opening round at Royal Cinque Ports turned on four holes through the turn. From the 9th to the 12th he collected 13 points. He birdied the 10th and played the other three in par, without dropping a single gross shot. Through the 11th he was level for the Trophy lead, which at Deal counts as something close to serenity. The 13th ended it. It is one of the harder holes on the course and it took a double bogey off him with no fuss

whatsoever. Mullin declined to be moved. He parred the 15th, the hardest hole out there, then parred the 16th, and that second one put him outright in front for the Trophy lead. He signed for 40 points, the best score of the round, and a gross 87. His previous best on the course, set on his only prior visit, was seven shots worse. The course had been asked a question and had not enjoyed answering it.

AT A GLANCE

ROUND OF THE DAY

David MULLIN (40 pts)

TROPHY LEAD

David MULLIN, 3 ahead

GREEN JACKET LEAD

David MULLIN, 5 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD

DM 40 | AB 37 | GW 33 | JB 29

ROUND GROSS

DM +15 | JB +20 | GW +21 | AB +26

AFTER R1 • TROPHY

DM 40 | AB 37 | GW 33 | JB 29

AFTER R1 • GREEN JACKET

DM +15 | JB +20 | GW +21 | AB +26

WOODEN SPOON

Jon Baker Slips to the Spoon

Triple bogeys at the 3rd and 5th cost him the round before the turn, though three straight pars from the 11th kept him second in the Green Jacket.

Jon Baker came to Royal Cinque Ports for his second visit holding the best round this field has ever played there, an 85 in the TEG 13 Trophy. Round one of the TEG 14 Trophy took a different view. He shot 92, handing back seven shots on his own high-water mark. The damage was done early and done thoroughly. A double bogey at the 2nd. A triple at the par-5 3rd. A bogey at the short 4th,

one of the easiest holes on the course. Then a triple at the 5th and a bogey at the 6th. Five holes, not one net par among them, and a swift descent to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon race. There was a reprieve. Three straight pars from the 11th brought him nine Stableford points and the brief look of a man who remembered how this worked. It arrived far too late to alter anything. Baker

ended round one last in the Trophy standings, and bottom of the Spoon race as well. The man who owns the best round ever played at Deal spent the evening propping up both tables. Ahead of him, David Mullin's 87 held the lead in the Trophy and the Green Jacket alike.

ALEX BAKER

Alex Baker's Ten at the Sixteenth

An 8 at the 11th and a 10 at the par-five 16th returned nothing at all, and the round was still four shots better than anything he had managed at Deal before.

Alex Baker's round at Royal Cinque Ports Golf Club moved between fine golf and open calamity, often within a single hole. Three consecutive doubles at the 3rd, 4th and 5th removed six shots from his card before anyone had settled. He then parred the 6th and drew level for the lead in the

2021 Green Jacket (Gross), which is the sort of thing that encourages a man. The encouragement was misplaced. An 8 at the 11th, one of the course's hardest holes, was followed by a quintuple-bogey 10 at the 16th. Two holes, nine shots surrendered, and not a word of complaint

from the scorecard. Baker still walked off with 37 Stableford points and a gross 98. That is four shots better than his previous best here, and a personal best at the course. A promising start, an expensive middle, two craters, and a record. Deal gave him everything except peace.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 14, Round 1